Door Leaf

W: 105 cm; H: 203 cm

Hall 4

Inv. no. 485



Door leaf with a central panel organised around a repeating field of hexagons bisected at their midpoints to generate a secondary grid of interlocking diamonds, in a pattern known locally as mosadas sarw. This geometric core is framed by a plain border and a further border of regular and elongated hexagons, with undecorated panels flanking the top and bottom of the leaf. Designs of this type enjoyed a long history in Cairo and are characteristic of both the Mamluk and Ottoman periods. Comparable doors can be found in Manzil Zaynab Khatun (872-73 AH / 1468 CE, with Ottoman additions in 1125 AH / 1713 CE) and Bayt al-Suhaymi (1057-58 and 1210-11 AH / 1648 and 1796 CE), making precise dating difficult in the absence of firm provenance.

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